s S l c English race MODULE 01
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1.COMPREHENSION QUESTIONs

Read the extract from the lesson "A very old man with enormous wings" and answer the questions that follow:

But when they went out in to the courtyard at the first light of dawn, they found the whole neighbourhood in front of the chicken coop having fun with the angel. The visitors were tossing him things to eat through the openings in the coop. It was as if weren't a supernatural creature but a circus animal.

The news of the captive angel spread with great rapidity. After a few hours, the courtyard had the bustle of a market place. The couple had to call in troops to disperse the mob.

1.Why did the whole neighbourhood appear in the courtyard?

2.How did the visitors treat the angel?

3.Why do they consider the old man as a captive angel?

4.Pick out the word from the passage that means 'early morning'.

5.Why did the couple seek the support of armed forces?

Answers

1. Because the news of the captive angel spread rapidly and people gathered out of curiosity.
2. They treated the angel like a circus animal, throwing food at him.
3. Because the old man had wings and was kept confined in a chicken coop.
4. **Dawn**
5. Because the courtyard became overcrowded and chaotic, and they needed to disperse the mob.

2. Profile

Write a short profile of Wladyslaw Szpilman

Born	: 5 December 1911, Sosnowiec, Poland
Nationality	: Polish
Occupation	: Composer, house pianist in Polish radio from 1935.
Works	: 500 works including piano pieces. songs, film scores.
Memoir	: The Pianist published in 1946, adapted into a film in 2002.
Died	: 6 July 2000, Warsaw, Poland.

Władysław Szpilman

Władysław Szpilman was a famous Polish composer and pianist, born on 5 December 1911

in Sosnowiec, Poland. He gained recognition as a talented musician and worked as a house pianist for Polish Radio from 1935. Szpilman composed around 500 works, including piano pieces, songs, and film scores, which established his reputation in the world of music. He is best remembered for his memoir *The Pianist*, published in 1946, which recounts his harrowing experiences during World War II. The memoir was later adapted into an acclaimed film in 2002. Szpilman passed away on 6 July 2000 in Warsaw, Poland.

Write a short profile of Gabriel Garcia Marquez based on the following hints.

- Birth : March 6, 1927, Columbia
- Education : University of Cartagena
- Famous as : Novelist, Short story writer, Journalist
- Major works : One Hundred Years of Solitude, The Autumn of the Patriarch, Love in the Time of Cholera
- Awards : Neustadt International Prize for Literature (1972)
- The Nobel Prize for Literature (1982)
- Death : April 17, 2014

Gabriel Garcia Marquez (1927 - 2014)

Gabriel Garcia Marquez, a famous Colombian novelist, short story writer and journalist was born on 6 March 1927 in Colombia. He was one of the greatest writers of the 20th century. He had his education from the University of Cartagena. His great works are One Hundred Years of Solitude, The Autumn of the Patriarch, and Love in the Time of Cholera. He received numerous prestigious awards including the Neustadt International Prize for Literature in 1972. He was awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature in 1982. He passed away on 17 April, 2014.

3. Character sketches

Pelayo is the central character in the story. He is a responsible and a simple character in the story. Pelayo is the father of the child and Elisenda's husband. He lives in a coastal village in Columbia. He discovers the old man with enormous wings in his courtyard after the storm.

He was confused in the beginning of the story. It was a strange sight for him to see the old man in his courtyard. Pelayo quits his job and builds a new larger house.

Elisenda is the central character in the story. She is clever. She is described as a selfish character in the story. She thought of making money using the old man as an exhibit. she was cruel to him; People came in large numbers from all over to see the old man. She used the money to build a large mansion and so they led a luxurious life.

The old man is a central character in the story. He is dressed in dirty clothing and is very dirty. His condition is pity He is filthy and senile. He first appears in the backyard of Pelayo's house after rain. Pelayo and Elisenda kept the old man in their chicken coop. The old man continues to stay with them in the chicken coop. The people treated the old man like a circus animal.

Szpilman is a polish Jew and a talented pianist. He had been living during the World War 11. He lost his home, family in the War. He had been working in the polish radio before the World War 11. He recounts his terrifying experience of hiding in an attic. The German police officer secretly supported him and provided him all the help for his safe stay in the attic. He struggled a lot to save his life.

4.Diary

Pelayo writes a diary entry after seeing the old man in his courtyard.

Monday 15th June2026 7.00 pm

It is an unforgettable day in my life. I don't know what to do. It confuses me a lot. I have never seen such a strange creature with enormous wings in my courtyard. He is an unexpected guest. It frightens me I am worried about it. I do not know anything about it. I collected the courage to see it. Was it a human being. Did it come from another planet? Where did it have come from? I don't know who brought it here. It is a curious sight for everyone.

Szpilman recounts his terrifying experience in the attic during the hiding. He notes down his feelings and thoughts in a diary.

Monday 15th June 2026 7.00 pm

It is a shocking day in my life. I don't know anything about it. It is hard to remember this day in my life. But the German officer supported and guided me well. I struggled a lot. Luckily no one caught me. It is my fortune to stay there happily. It is a great relief. I can't forget this day. No one harmed me. I am afraid of police. No could discover my stay there. They searched me everywhere.

5.informal letter

Pelayo writes a letter to his friend describing the horrible appearance of the old man in his courtyard.

Garden villa

MG Road

Mumbai.

10th November 2025.

My dear friend,

How are you? Hope you are fine. I am fine here. I am writing this letter with a special purpose. I am very happy and excited. I like to share happy news with you. There is an old man in my courtyard after the storm. It is a curious sight for everyone. It has enormous wings too. I don't want to disturb it. A neighbour lady came and helped me. It is a great relief. She said it is an angel. Her support changed my life completely.

Share my love to all.

Yours lovingly,

Name

Prepare a write up on the arrival of the very old man with enormous wings.

The old man is very old, bold toothless and dressed in rags. He was washed ashore from the sea. Pelayo and his wife Elisenda carefully examined this human. He has enormous wings too. The couple put him in a chicken coop at night. They suspect him that he is a castaway from a ship. A neighbour woman said that he is an angel. The next morning the courtyard is full of anxious visitors. They came to see the angel. The couple charged an entry fee to see the angel. They made a lot of money from the visitors. So, they became rich and led luxurious life. Finally, the old man flew up into the skies.

5. Conversation

Imagine the piano scene and draft a conversation with a minimum of five exchanges happened between the officer and Szpilman.

Officer: Why are you hiding here?
Szpilman: I do not have a home.

Officer: What did you do before the war?
Szpilman: I was a piano player.

Officer: Is there a piano here?
Szpilman: Yes, in the next room.

Officer: Can you play it?
Szpilman: yes, I can try.

Officer: Your music is beautiful.
Szpilman: Thank you.

Unseen passage

1.Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.
Social media has transformed the way people communicate and share information. It allows instant connection across the globe, but it also raises concerns such as misinformation, addiction, and loss of privacy. While social media can educate and inspire, responsible use is essential to avoid its negative impact on mental health and relationships.

1. What is one major benefit of social media mentioned in the passage?
2. Mention one concern associated with social media use.
3. Which statement best summarises the passage?
   A) Social media should be banned
   B) Social media has only advantages
   C) Social media needs responsible use
   D) Social media replaces education
4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a concern?
   A) Addiction
   B) Misinformation
   C) Loss of privacy
   D) Physical illness

Choose the correct option:
i) Only D ii) A and D iii) B and C iv) C and D

Answers

1. One major benefit of social media:
   It allows instant connection and communication across the globe.
2. One concern associated with social media use:
   Misinformation.
   (Other acceptable answers: addiction or loss of privacy)
3. Correct summary of the passage:
   C) social media needs responsible use
4. Concern NOT mentioned in the passage:
   Only D

11. Using the clues given below, write a biographical sketch of Dr A P J Abdul Kalam.

- Born: 1931, Tamil Nadu
- Aerospace scientist
- Key role in India's missile programme
- President of India (2002–2007)
- Known as "People's President"
- Author of Wings of Fire

Dr A. P. J. Abdul Kalam

Dr A. P. J. Abdul Kalam was born in 1931 in Tamil Nadu, India. He was a famous aerospace scientist. He played a key role in India's missile programme. He became the President of India from 2002 to 2007. He was known as people's president. He is the author of Wings *of Fire*.

111. Prepare a notice announcing an Inter-School Literary Fest organized by your school. Include date, time, venue, events, and eligibility.

NOTICE
MODEL SCHOOL, ALUVA
Inter-School Literary Fest

Dear friends,

The English club is organizing an **Inter-School Literary Fest** for students. Interested students should give their names to their class teacher. Famous film actor Mammooty is the chief guest. Come and enjoy the programme. All are welcome.

Date: 15 March 2026
Time; 10.00am
Venue: School Hall
Events: Storytelling, Poetry Recitation, Drawing with Words

Convenor

Aluva

English Club

10 March 2026

1V. Frame four WH-questions based on the passage below.

Success does not come overnight. It demands patience, hard work, and the courage to face failure. Those who learn from mistakes grow stronger and wiser, while those who fear failure never discover their true potential.

What does success need?
What do we learn from mistakes?
What is the title of the passage?
Who faces failure?
What does it demand patience?
Who grows stronger?
Who becomes wiser?
What do we learn from the passage?
Why does success not come overnight?
What qualities are needed to achieve success?
How do people grow stronger and wiser?